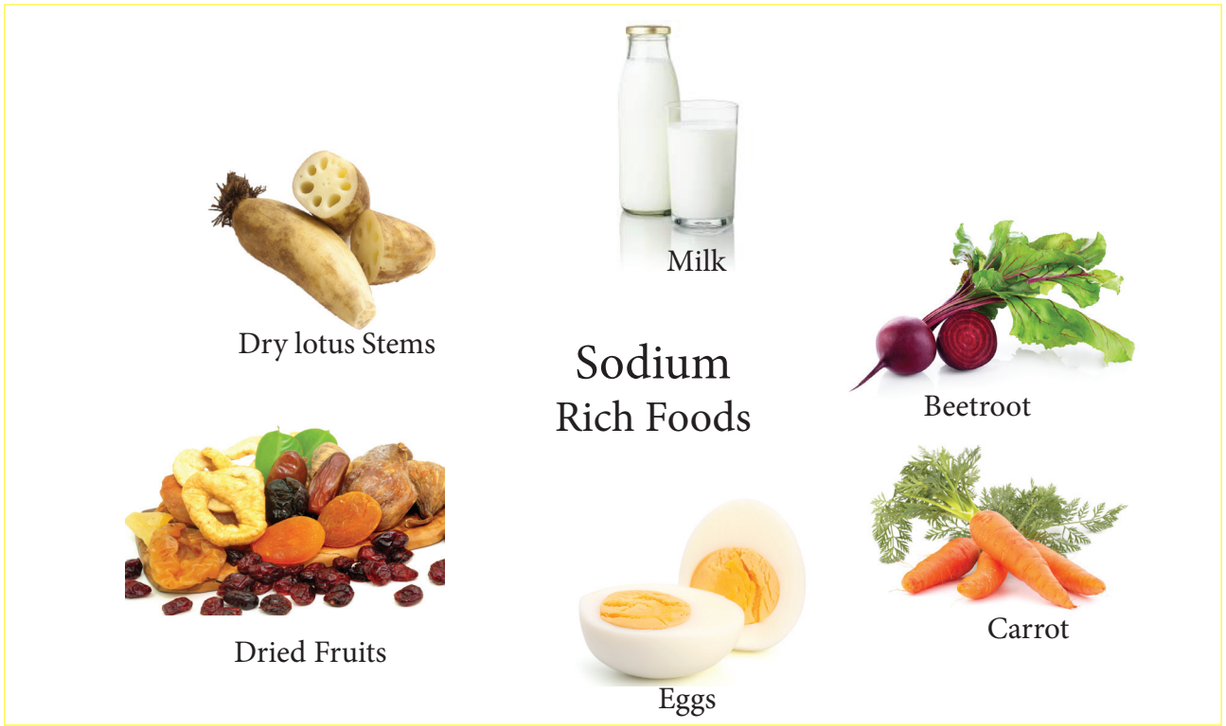


Fig 11.26: Food Sources of Sodium

- Too much sodium may lead to water retention, high blood pressure and even stomach ulcers.

11.5 WATER

Water is vital for human existence. Water is the largest component of the human body, making up to 60 to 70 percent of the total body's weight. This percentage of water in human being is required to be maintained. Infants have greater percentage of water than adults. Ageing declines the water percentage of the body. Water is second only to oxygen in its vital importance to the body. One can live without food for a longer time than one does without water. Water is colourless, calorie less compound of hydrogen and oxygen that virtually every cell in the body needs to survive.

Substances dissolve in water as ions with positive and negative charge. They are called electrolytes. The common electrolytes in our body are sodium, potassium and chloride. Because of this, water can dissolve most substances and in doing so, it enables minerals and other chemicals to undergo biological reactions in the body.

DO YOU KNOW...?



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